PHASE 2: REFINED CONCEPTS & STRATEGIC EXECUTION

Awash Ikhlas

Rebranding Identity & Visual Strategy

Visualizing Trust & Sharia Compliance: A definitive corporate identity engineered for operational segregation, ethical prosperity, and cross-channel consistency.

PREPARED FOR
Awash Bank Branding and Trade Marketing Directorate

CREATIVE PARTNER
Design Plus

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Refining the Vision: A Strategic Response

Thank you for your precise and constructive feedback. For this revision, we focused our design process entirely on your three core directives:

01 / OBJECTIVE

Radical Simplification

Streamlining the geometry to ensure clean, memorable marks that guarantee flawless practical application across digital screens, print, and 3D signage.

02 / OBJECTIVE

Distinct Color & Typography

Expanding beyond a purely monochromatic palette to introduce a premium, modern aesthetic that gives Ikhlas its own unique character.

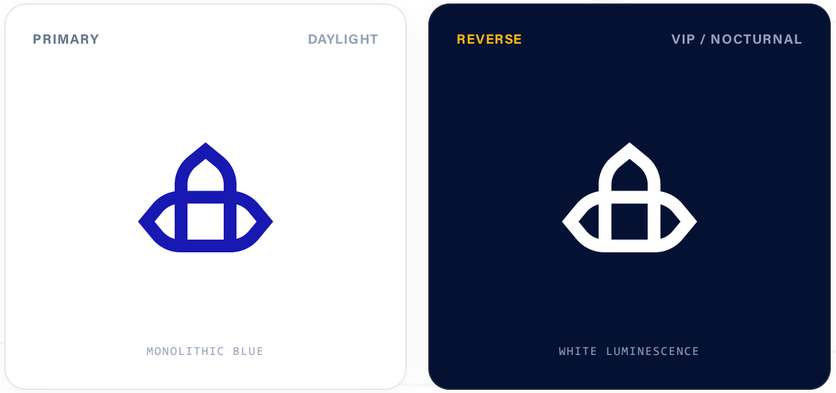
03 / OBJECTIVE

The 20/80 Balance

Ensuring 20% of the design visually roots the brand in the trusted Awash heritage, while 80% establishes a fresh, innovative, and highly distinct identity for Ikhlas in the Islamic banking sector.

CONCEPT 01 — ARCHITECTURAL MARK

Concept 1: The Monolithic Archway



01 / CLARITY

Absolute Clarity & Structural Trust

Addressing the request for ultimate simplicity, we distilled the archway into its purest geometric form. By utilizing a flat, monolithic structure in corporate Awash blue, this logo projects unshakeable financial stability and absolute clarity.

02 / METAPHOR

The Conceptual "Window"

The intersection of the vertical pillar and the horizontal foundational shape creates a literal "window" in the negative space. This visualizes Awash Bank's IFB "window model" operating seamlessly within its conventional branches.

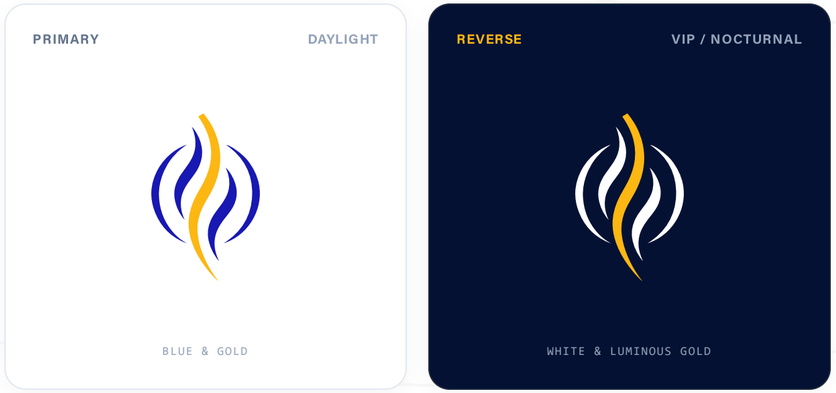
03 / MONOGRAM

Dual Monogram Integration

The geometry cleverly conceals a hidden monogram acting as the 20% connection to the parent brand: the overarching pointed structure forms an "A" for Awash, sheltering the central vertical "I" for Ikhlas.

CONCEPT 02 — FLUID MOMENTUM

Concept 2: The Dynamic Flow



01 / GROWTH

The River of Growth & Purity

Representing a complete creative leap to ensure we have a distinct array of options, this concept introduces fluid, ascending vertical waves. It captures the literal meaning of Ikhlas (purity) while symbolizing ethical financial growth, community nurture, and the life-giving Awash River heritage.

02 / CORE

Premium Distinctiveness & Sharia Core

The central ascending gold pillar represents the pure, Sharia-compliant core of the IFB service, nurtured and protected by the surrounding blue waves. The integration of gold elevates the brand, signaling wealth preservation and high-value ethical banking.

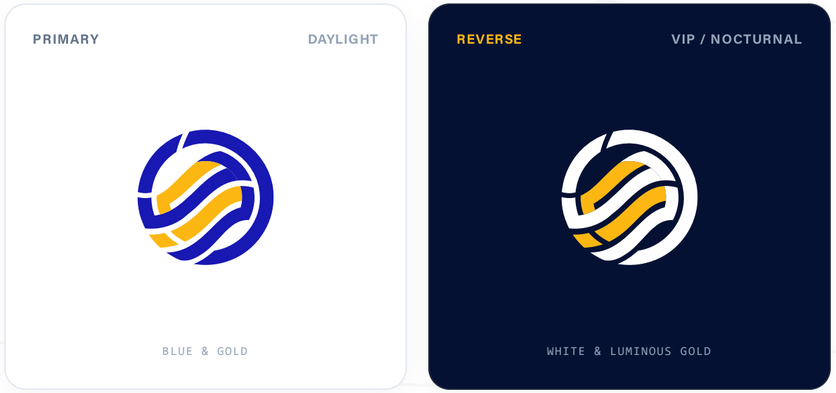
03 / HERITAGE

Subtle Corporate DNA

The 20% connection to the parent bank is elegantly subtle. The two outer blue arcs frame the design into a gentle globe silhouette, while the fluid inner lines evoke the movement and vital flow of the iconic "Awash River."

CONCEPT 03 — CALLIGRAPHIC HERITAGE

Concept 3: The Refined Woven Sphere



01 / REFINEMENT

Distinct Heritage, Streamlined for Tomorrow

We radically simplified our earlier woven concept by removing complex overlapping shadows, making it a bold, flat mark highly optimized for 3D physical signage and responsive digital scaling.

02 / BALANCE

The 20/80 Balance in Action

The outer circular boundary acts as the 20% connection, serving as a clear structural homage to the original Awash Bank globe. The 80% fresh identity is driven by dynamic inner lines forming the Arabic word *"Ikhlas"* (إخلاص).

03 / PALETTE

Expanded Color Architecture

Answering the call for a more distinctive identity, this concept breaks away from a monochromatic approach by introducing a striking Gold accent alongside trusted Awash Blue. This creates a premium, highly recognizable look that stands out in the IFB market.

EXECUTIVE DECISION FRAMEWORK ▪ STRATEGIC SCORECARD

Concept Comparison & Evaluation Matrix

Side-by-side performance appraisal across the Directorate's core directives: Awash heritage continuity, Sharia distinctiveness, production cost efficiency, and digital scalability.

CONCEPT 01

Monolithic Archway

20/80 Heritage Balance	30% / 70%
	Heavy parent brand arch anchor
Sharia Distinctiveness	Moderate
	Architectural "Window" metaphor
Production Cost Index	Lowest / Economical
	Solid flat geometry, easiest 3D cut
Digital App Scalability	High
	Clear favicon & 16px rendering

EVALUATION VERDICT

Solid Institutional Fallback

CONCEPT 02

The Dynamic Flow

20/80 Heritage Balance	15% / 85%
	High departure into ascending waves
Sharia Distinctiveness	High
	Ascending gold Sharia core
Production Cost Index	Moderate-High
	Tighter CNC contours on 3D letters
Digital App Scalability	Moderate
	Requires minimum stroke width

EVALUATION VERDICT

Progressive Kinetic Option

PRIMARY RECOMMENDATION

CONCEPT 03 96% Score

Refined Woven Sphere

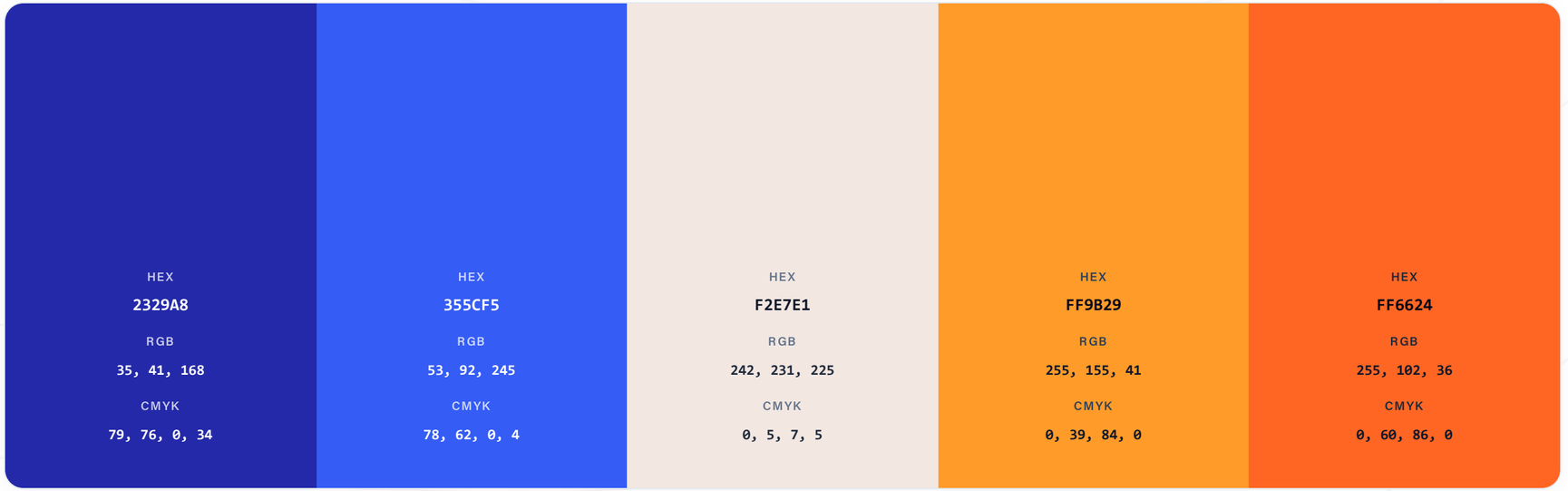
20/80 Heritage Balance	20% / 80% (Optimal)
	Awash globe silhouette + fresh interior
Sharia Distinctiveness	Exceptional / Highest
	Arabic "Ikhlas" (إخلاص) monogram
Production Cost Index	Cost-Effective
	Optimized channel letters & gold stamping
Digital App Scalability	Superior
	Native circular app icon & retina clarity

DIRECTORATE SELECTION

Endorsed Phase 2 Direction

Color Architecture

Bridging the corporate palette: starting from institutional Deep Indigo and Royal Blue, transitioning through neutral Sand, to warm Amber and vital Awash Orange.



Bilingual Modern Typography

Standardized on **Acumin Variable Concept** (Latin) and **Nyala Ethiopic** (Ge'ez): engineered for complete parity across international corporate communication and domestic Ethiopian banking touchpoints.

01 / LATIN STANDARD — GLOBAL & DIGITAL

Acumin Variable Concept

Neo-grotesque sans-serif designed by Robert Slimbach. Engineered for high-clarity headlines, digital app interfaces, and executive stationery.

PRIMARY LATIN WORDMARK

Awash Ikhlas Bank

Interest-Free Banking Directorate

Bold 800	Headlines, Hero Wordmarks & Signage
SemiBold 600	Subheadings, Table Data & Section Labels
Regular 400	Disclosures, Contracts & Editorial Body

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ • 0123456789

02 / ETHIOPIC STANDARD — NATIONAL & RETAIL

Nyala ◆ የኢትዮጵያ ፊደል

The premier Ethiopian typographic standard. Crafted for optimum legibility across passbooks, official legal documents, and branch counter reception.

PRIMARY ETHIOPIC WORDMARK

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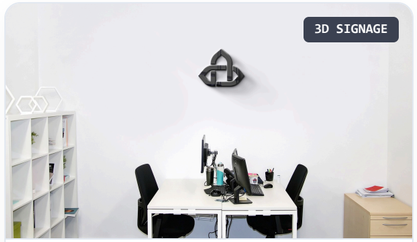
ደማቅ (Bold)	ዋና ርዕሶች እና የሕንፃ ላይ ምልክቶች
መካከለኛ (Medium)	ንዑሳን ርዕሶች እና ማብራሪያዎች
መደበኛ (Regular)	የሕግና የፋይናንስ ሰነዶች ዝርዝር ጽሑፍ

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PRODUCTION FEASIBILITY ▪ TOUCHPOINT VALIDATION

Engineered for Versatility

A modern logo must perform flawlessly in every environment. Every revised mark presented today has been rigorously stress-tested across key physical, digital, and print mediums:



01 / ARCHITECTURAL

3D Physical Scalability

Streamlined vectors optimized for 3D cut-out brass channel letters, illuminated acrylic fascias, and high-impact branch reception displays.



02 / AUTOMATED

ATM & Digital Banking

Unmistakable brand recognition across self-service ATMs, digital kiosk terminals, customer touchscreens, and responsive mobile interfaces.



03 / RETAIL BANKING

Official Bank Passbook

Flawless reproduction on security-tinted passbooks, account certificates, deposit slips, and official customer-facing documents.



04 / STATIONERY

Executive Collateral

Tactile debossing and gold foil application on premium executive business cards, correspondence folders, and directorate stationery.

EXECUTIVE NEXT STEPS

Moving Forward

Thank you for your continued collaboration. We believe these three distinct, refined concepts successfully bridge the trusted legacy of **Awash Bank** with the innovative, modern future of the **Ikhlas IFB initiative**.

We look forward to your thoughts on this new creative direction to finalize the Awash Ikhlas identity.

STAGE 01

Directorate Selection

Feedback collation & concept ratification

STAGE 02

Brand Guidelines

Comprehensive manual & vector master files

STAGE 03

Touchpoint Rollout

Branch signage pilot & digital deployment